

# Ricard Gardella

AI Engineer & Cybersecurity Specialist

Barcelona, Spain  
ricard.gardella.garcia@gmail.com  
ricardgardella.com  
linkedin.com/in/ricard-gardella-garcia  
github.com/ricardgardella

## SUMMARY

Senior AI engineer with 10+ years building intelligent, secure, data-driven systems across fintech, crypto, cybersecurity, retail, and logistics. Ships LLM-powered applications in production and breaks them on weekends through bug bounties and CTF.

## EXPERIENCE

### Senior AI Engineer · Checktrade

Apr 2026 — Present

London, UK (Remote)

- Building AI-powered features for the UK's leading home-improvement platform — LLMs, RAG, MCP, A2A, ADK, and multi-agent workflows in production.

**Stack:** Python · AWS · LLMs · RAG · MCP · A2A · ADK · Agents · Terraform · Kubernetes · Docker · CI/CD · Digger · DataDog · ArgoCD · GCP

### Lead AI Engineer, Cybersecurity · Zynap

Oct 2024 — May 2026

Barcelona, Spain (Hybrid)

- Joined as an early hire and built Zynap's AI and Data functions from zero.
- Designed and shipped **NINA AI** — multi-agent conversational co-pilot for security engineers and SOC analysts (workflow automation, diagnostics, threat intel, malware analysis).
- Built ingestion platform processing **1B+ records/month** ensuring preemptive threat detection.
- Migrated critical query path from MongoDB to Elasticsearch — **67.5% faster** queries.
- Built Dark Web threat-intelligence pipeline spanning **5+ sources**.

**Stack:** Python · FastAPI · Go · LLMs · Multi-agent · LangGraph · Elasticsearch · Local LLMs · Threat Intel · ADK · DataDog · Terraform · Kubernetes · Docker · CI/CD · Gitlab · GCP · AWS · MongoDB

### Senior Data Engineer · Bitpanda

Feb 2023 — Nov 2024

Barcelona, Spain (Hybrid)

- Led end-to-end design and implementation of Bitpanda's data platform, supporting **4M+ daily transactions**.
- Built **50+ ingestion jobs** (hourly/daily) feeding the data lake from internal and external sources.
- Rolled out dbt across **4 product teams**, decentralising data ownership. After the initial rollout, dbt has been adopted by the entire company **15+ teams**.
- Mentored **3+** engineers and managed interns.

**Stack:** Snowflake · dbt · Airflow · Kafka · Python · AWS · Terraform · Astronomer · Datadog · AWS · Gitlab · Iceberg

### Data Engineer & Tech Lead · Inditex

Aug 2022 — Feb 2023

Barcelona, Spain (Remote)

- Designed data models for the Sustainability division — ESG reporting consumed by leadership and regulators across the world's largest fashion group.
- Built **50+ data objects** with millions of records, impacting **5+ teams**.
- Improved CI/CD pipelines, reducing deployment time and cost by **20%**.
- Tech-lead role across standards, code review, and engineer onboarding. Technical mentor for **5+** engineers.

**Stack:** Snowflake · Azure · Azure SQL · SQL · Tech Lead · Github · Docker

### Data Engineer · Goin

Jan 2021 — Jul 2022

Barcelona, Spain (Hybrid)

- Built data pipelines and the recommendation API powering personalised financial insights for **500K+ active users**.
- Built the data platform end-to-end, including **100+** KPI dashboards.

**Stack:** Python · FastAPI · PostgreSQL · GCP · Docker · Github · Datadog · Terraform · Kubernetes · CI/CD

London, UK (Remote)

- Built the entire data function **0→1** for a fast-growing UK last-mile logistics startup — pipelines, warehouse, reporting, analytics from scratch.

**Stack:** Airflow · Python · 0→1 · Team Building · SuperSet · Metabase · Tableau · PowerBI

SKILLS

|               |                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Languages     | Python · SQL · Go · TypeScript · Bash                                                                                                       |
| AI / ML       | LLMs · RAG · Multi-agent systems · LangChain · LangGraph · OpenAI · Anthropic · Local LLM deployment · Vector DBs · ADK · A2A · MCP · MLOps |
| Data          | Snowflake · dbt · Airflow · Kafka · Spark · Elasticsearch · PostgreSQL · MongoDB · Redshift · Astronomer                                    |
| Cloud / Infra | AWS · GCP · Azure · Terraform · Docker · Kubernetes · CI/CD · Digger                                                                        |
| Security      | AI Red Teaming · Bug Bounty · Threat Intel · OSINT · CTF · Web Exploitation                                                                 |

EDUCATION

|                                                                                      |             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| M.Sc. in Innovation and Research in Informatics (MIRI), Data Science specialty       | 2017 — 2019 |
| Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya (UPC)                                           |             |
| Thesis: Travel-time forecasting using probe-vehicle data on freeways — Grade 9.5/10. |             |
| BSc Computer Engineering                                                             | 2013 — 2017 |
| Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya                                                 |             |

CERTIFICATIONS

- HTB Certified Web Exploitation Specialist — Hack The Box (Apr 2026)
- Databricks Lakehouse Fundamentals — Databricks (Dec 2022)
- Big Data Analytics — Barcelona Supercomputing Center (Feb 2019)
- Applied Machine Learning in Python — Coursera / U. Michigan (Jul 2018)
- Cambridge Certificate in Advanced English (CAE) — Cambridge Assessment English

NOTABLE

- **Fraunhofer Institute Prize** — HackCorona (2020), AI Ventilator Assistant chatbot.
- **Best Data Science Project** — HackEPS 2018, ML solution for BonÀrea retail challenge.
- Active on Hack The Box and private bug-bounty programs.

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native) · Catalan (native) · English (C1 / CAE) · Japanese (basic)